

PART I

Q1. Morpho-Syntax problem [15 marks]

The Yoruba language belongs to Kwa branch of Niger Congo language family. Below are phrases given by To Xenia Guiliarova in Yoruba with English equivalents.

A. Study them and answer the given questions (14-21). [8 marks]

To Xenia Guiliarova

Below you see phrases in the Yoruba language (in phonetic transcription) and their literal English translations:

1. [aɟɔ ɔkɔ] the husband's dog
2. [ìlẹ̀ ɛlu] the stranger's city
3. [igi ìyá] the mother's tree
4. [ɔka àɟé] the witch's husband
5. [ìfó owó] the love of money
6. [èbó orí] the vicinity of the head (i.e., near the head)
7. [iyá alé] the house's mother (i.e., mistress of the house, elder wife)
8. [àɟé ẹ̀lú] the city's witch (i.e., the city witch)
9. [àkẹ́ ẹgi] the axe of the tree (i.e., a wooden axe)
10. [owó olé] the money of the house (i.e., rent)
11. [ìlú ùfẹ́] the city of love
12. [orá aɟá] the dog's head
13. [igo ɔkɔ] the husband's tree

Translate into English:

14. [owá àkẹ́]
15. [èbá ẹ̀lú]
16. [ɔkɔ òyá]
17. [aɟé ɛlu]

Translate into Yoruba:

18. the head of the tree (i.e., the top of the tree)
19. the witch's city
20. the house of love (venue of the creation of the first human beings in Yoruba mythology)
21. the husband's axe

Note. ɟ and y are specific consonants, ɛ and ɔ are specific vowels of the Yoruba language (similar to e and o, respectively). The marks « ´ » and « ` » indicate the so-called tones (a higher or lower level of the voice during the pronunciation of the syllable).

Answers:

14.

15.

16.

17.

18.

19.

20.

21.

B. What is the key observation from the above data? [2 marks]

C. Taking any 5 examples from Yoruba data, compare similar genitive structures in English and another language you know. State the similarities and differences. [5 marks]

Q2. Word association [10 marks]

Building vocabulary is an important aspect of language development. We store not just words in our memory. We store them along with other words belonging to the same semantic field or sharing certain semantic relations. Given below are two lists of words: M and N. For the words in list M, select the word/s from list N which you think is associated with it. A word from the list N may be used more than once. Name the relation between each pair of words.

M [black, big, pure, rain, open, book, balcony, home, glass, public]

N [brother, private, ticket, close, white, small, water, library, house, magic]

Q3. Translation and Analysis [10 marks]

Translate the following text into your mother tongue. Compare and analyse the two languages (source and target) using examples from the original and translated data.

Note: Roman script is allowed. You may number the sentences, underline the words or mark any linguistic feature in any way you want. But it should be clear and readable.

A politician visited an Indian village and asked about their needs.

"We have two basic needs, sir," replied a villager.

"First, we have a hospital, but there's no doctor."

Hearing this, the politician took out his cell phone and, after speaking for a while, reassured the villager that a doctor would be there the next day. He then asked about the second problem.

"Second, sir, there is no cell phone coverage anywhere in the village."

PART II

Answer the questions in the Answer Booklet

Q4. Answer any three questions. [3 x 10 = 30 marks]

Write an essay on:

- (i) India as a linguistic area [based on Emeneau's and modern studies]
- (ii) Chomsky's vs Greenberg's approach to language universal study
- (iii) Phonological universals
- (iv) Mirror image relation between OV and VO languages

Q5. Answer any six questions. [6 x 5 = 30 marks]

Write short essay on:

- (i) Relation between language development and language loss
- (ii) Causative constructions
- (iii) Implicational universals
- (iv) Morphological typology
- (v) Ergative-Absolutive vs Nominative-Accusative
- (vi) Broca's vs Wernicke's aphasia
- (vii) Relative clause constructions

Q6. Critical thinking [5 marks]

Based on the learnings from this course, write how one can apply CL/NLP techniques for study in language typology and universals. Also, how findings in language typology and universals will help in advancement of CL/NLP research.